4. Line 2 of First Cave Inscription. Hultzsch (1925): 181.

5. Lines 1 and 2 of Second Cave Inscription, ibid.

6. Third Cave Inscription, ibid.: 182.

7. Forster (1924): 198.

8. Falk (2008): 246.

9. See Gupta (1980): 206–9 for an excellent reconstruction of the process. The summary here presented is based on his description and my field observations.

10. Basham (1981): 135–7.

11. Poonacha (2013): 447, 466.

12. *Mahavamsa* X.96–102; Geiger (1912): 75.

13. Cunningham (1892): 4.

14. Coomaraswamy (1927): 33.

15. Sinha (2000): 9.

16. Watters (1904–5): 115.

17. Cunningham (1892): 76.

18. Bidari (2007): 83–5 cites such episodes from the life of Konakamana.

19. Xuanzang, for instance, wrote about it in the seventh century CE: 'To the north-east of the town of Krakuchchhanda Buddha, going about 30 li, we come to an old capital (or, great city) in which there is a stupa. This is to commemorate the spot where, in the Bhadra-kalpa when men lived to the age of 40,000 years, Kanakamuni Buddha was born . . . Further north there is a stupa containing the relics of his bequeathed body; in front of it is a stone pillar with a lion on the top, and about 20 feet high; on this is inscribed a record of the events connected with his *Nirvana*; this was built by Ashoka-raja.' Beal (1884): vol. III, 272.

20. Chakrabarti (2001): 191. There is a very useful section in Chakrabarti's book on the archaeological geography of this stretch.

21. Mukherji (1901): 1.

22. For a long time after Cunningham's survey, the location of Kapilavastu remained uncertain. This is why Vincent Smith, in his instructions to P.C. Mukherji—who undertook a tour of the Nepal terai—asked him to 'first try and fix the position of Kapilavastu, as a whole, accurately as possible.' Smith (1901): 1. The location of Kapilavastu, though, still remains controversial with academics